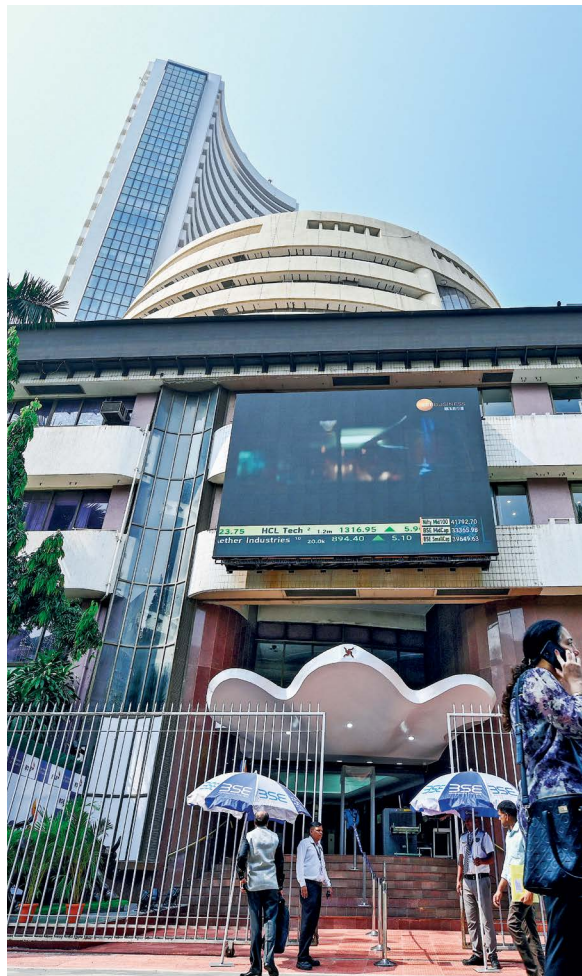


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THEN AND NOW
1. BROKERS ON THE TRADING FLOOR OF THE BSE IN 1985 2. A VIEW OF THE ENTRANCE TO THE BSE IN RECENT TIMES

space—where brokers place their servers for faster access—that had been languishing, has been sold out now. There are around 50 foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) that trade in the BSE's F&O segment that sees the participation of around 350 broking entities as well.

More importantly, around 1.5 million investors regularly trade in Sensex derivatives, though Ramamurthy aims to have 15 million investors on board for a proper deepening of the market.

While he knows that the exchange needs more brokers and FPIs for institutional deepening of the derivatives segment and, once that happens, he can even look at more products, his efforts till date have certainly not gone unnoticed.

A BULLISH UNDERTONE

Ramamurthy's steps have found favour with those who track the markets. "BSE has embarked on a multi-year transformation journey under new management... we

expect BSE to move ahead to monetise its success in the derivatives market through improved product pricing and co-location income," stated a recent report by global financial major Jefferies.

In a similar context, HDFC Securities, in a detailed report released in November last year, stated that the exchange's gain in market share in the derivatives segment is quite impressive, which also improves revenue visibility with better profitability.